Moving to Your New Laptop

From your old Chromebook to your new Acer laptop, step by step

BEFORE YOU START

- [ ] The old Chromebook and the new laptop, both charged and plugged in
- [ ] A working Wi-Fi connection
- [ ] Your Google account email and password (the one you sign into the old Chromebook with)
- [ ] Your phone nearby, in case Google sends a sign-in code

TWO BASICS ON THE OLD CHROMEBOOK

- **Right-click:** tap the touchpad with two fingers at the same time. That opens the menu with Copy, Paste and New folder.
- **The Files app:** click the circle in the bottom-left corner of the screen, type **Files**, and press Enter.

PART 1 Find the files saved on the old Chromebook

Do this on the old Chromebook.

1. **Open the Files app.**
   Click the circle in the bottom-left corner, type **Files**, and press Enter.

2. **Click “My files” in the left-hand column.**
   Everything under My files is stored only on this Chromebook. The most important folder is **Downloads**, which is where email attachments, saved PDFs and screenshots usually land. Click it and look at what is there.

3. **Check the other folders under My files.**
   You may also see folders such as **Play files** (from Android apps) or **Linux files**. If either one holds files you want to keep, make a note of it. If you don’t see them, that’s fine.

4. **Find Google Drive in the same left-hand column.**
   Below My files you’ll see **Google Drive**, with **My Drive** inside it. Anything already in there is safe and will show up on the new Chromebook on its own.

PART 2 Copy those files into Google Drive

Still on the old Chromebook.

5. **Make a new folder in My Drive.**
   Click **My Drive**. Right-click on an empty white area, choose **New folder**, name it **From old Chromebook**, and press Enter. (The shortcut is `ctrl` + `e`.)

6. **Go back to My files → Downloads and select the files.**
   To select everything in the folder, press `ctrl` + `a`. To pick only some, hold `ctrl` and click each one.

7. **Copy them.**
Right-click on one of the selected files and choose **Copy**, or press `ctrl` + `c`. Please use Copy, never Cut or Move, so the originals stay put until you've checked the new machine.

8. **Paste them into your new folder.**
Open **My Drive → From old Chromebook**, right-click on an empty area, and choose **Paste**, or press `ctrl` + `v`.

9. **Wait for the upload to finish.**
A progress message appears in the bottom-right corner of the screen. Leave the Chromebook open, plugged in, and on Wi-Fi until it says it's done. A lot of files can take a while, and that's normal.

10. **Repeat for any other folder you noted in step 3.**
Copy and paste each one into **From old Chromebook** the same way.

11. **Double-check that everything arrived.**
Open the Chrome browser and go to **drive.google.com**. Open the **From old Chromebook** folder and make sure your files are listed there.

PART 3 Set up the new laptop

Now switch to the new Acer laptop. It runs Windows, so it won't sync from the Chromebook on its own. These steps bring everything across through your Google account.

12. **If Google offers to create a passkey, choose "Not now."**
That's the "Sign in faster" box. You can set it up later if you'd like it.

13. **Install Google Chrome.**
In the browser that's already open (Microsoft Edge), go to **google.com/chrome** and click **Download Chrome**. Open the file when it finishes and follow the prompts. If Edge suggests you don't need Chrome, you can ignore that.

14. **Sign into Chrome and turn on sync.**
Open Chrome, click the round profile icon in the top-right corner, and choose **Turn on sync**. Sign in with the same Google account you use on the Chromebook, then click **Yes, I'm in**. Your bookmarks and saved passwords will fill in over the next few minutes.

15. **Make Chrome your main browser.**
If Chrome asks to become your default browser, say yes. Then right-click the Chrome icon in the bar along the bottom of the screen and choose **Pin to taskbar**, so it's always one click away.

16. **Open your email.**
In Chrome, go to **gmail.com**. Your emails all live with Google, so everything will be there. To add your other email accounts, click your profile picture in the top-right corner of Gmail and choose **Add another account**.

17. **Open your files.**
Go to **drive.google.com**, open the **From old Chromebook** folder, and open two or three files to make sure they look right.

PART 4 Check before you retire the old Chromebook

- [ ] My files open on the new laptop
- [ ] Gmail and Google Drive look the way they always do
- [ ] My other email accounts are added
- [ ] My bookmarks are in Chrome
- [ ] Websites I log into still remember my passwords

Keep the old Chromebook just as it is for a couple of weeks. Please don't reset or erase it (Chromebooks call this **Powerwash**) until we've talked, so there's always a way back if something turns up missing.

One more thing: if Windows ever asks whether to turn on **Recall** or save "snapshots" of your screen, choose **No** for now. Given the client paperwork you handle, it's worth talking through first.

STOP AND REACH OUT IF

- Any screen asks you to erase, reset or Powerwash.
- A pop-up asks you to buy or renew antivirus protection. Windows already has protection built in, so close it and let me know.
- You see an error message, or a message that your Google storage is full.
- The upload hasn't moved for a long time.
- Something just doesn't look right.

Take a photo of the screen with your phone and send it to me. We can finish the rest together on a short video call, where you share your screen and I walk you through it.

ABOUT YOUR FILES

Everything in this guide stays inside your own Google account. Your files move from the old Chromebook into your own Google Drive, and nothing goes to us or to any new service.
